



Your Diabetes Care Schedule

MAY 15, 2024 • ESPAÑOL



For Everyone

KEY POINTS

- Use this list to stay on schedule with self-checks, exams, and appointments throughout the year.
- Got questions? Ask your doctor about a referral for diabetes self-management education and support (DSMES) services.



Every day

Blood sugar checks. Check up to several times a day as directed by your doctor. Keep a record of your numbers and share with your health care team during your next visit.

Foot check. Use a mirror if you can't see the bottom of your feet or ask a family member for help. Let your doctor know immediately if you have any:

- Cuts, sores, or blisters
- Redness or swelling
- Corns or calluses
- Other change to the skin or nails

Diabetes medicines. Take the amount prescribed by your doctor, even when you feel good.

Physical activity. On most days, get 30 minutes of moderate activity, such as brisk walking or riding a bike. Aim for at least 150 minutes a week.

Healthy eating. Eat healthy foods that give you the nutrition you need and help your blood sugar stay in your target range.

Every 3 months

A1C test. If your treatment has changed or you're having trouble meeting your blood sugar goals, have this test every 3 months.

Doctor visit. If you're having trouble meeting your treatment goals, visit your doctor every 3 months. Your blood pressure and weight will be checked, and your self-care plan and medicines will be reviewed. Ask your doctor to check your feet if you've ever had diabetes-related foot problems.

Every 6 months

A1C test. If you're meeting your treatment and blood sugar goals, have this test every 6 months.

Doctor visit. If you're meeting your treatment goals, visit your doctor every 6 months. Your blood pressure and weight will be checked, and your self-care plan and medicines will be reviewed. Ask your doctor to check your feet if you've ever had diabetes-related foot problems.

Every year

- **Flu shot**
- [Kidney tests](#)
- **Cholesterol test**
- [Dilated eye exam](#) (more often if you have diabetes-related eye problems)
- [Hearing check](#)
- [Complete foot check](#) (more often if you have ever had diabetes-related foot problems)
- [Dental exam](#) (more often if your doctor recommends; let your dentist know you have diabetes)

Just once

Pneumonia shot. Get a pneumonia shot as an adult before you're 65. You'll need two more doses when you're 65 or older.

Hepatitis B shot. Get a hepatitis B shot if you're 60 or younger and haven't had the shot before. Talk to your doctor about getting the shot if you're over 60.

As needed

[Mental health check.](#) Let your doctor know right away if you're feeling sad or hopeless so you can get help.

New symptoms or health problems. If health problems are getting worse or if you notice new ones, call your doctor for an evaluation.

SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

CONTENT SOURCE:
[National Center for Chronic Disease Prevention and Health Promotion; Diabetes](#)

ABOUT THIS PAGE

Published: May 15, 2024

Updated: November 6, 2023

This page was last updated on this date. Updates may include minor edits, image changes, or other modifications to page content.

Reviewed: May 15, 2024

The information on this page was last reviewed by subject matter experts to ensure accuracy.